Yale Fellowship Committee Chair Guidelines & Disagreement Arbitration

Procedural Rules for Panel Discussion, Quorum, and Final Authorization

Section 1: Disagreement Threshold & Round 2 Deliberation

1. Discrepancy Trigger:

• If evaluator scores on any applicant differ by **≥ 2.0 points** (e.g., Academic Evaluator gives 4.5 while Budget Evaluator gives 2.0), Round 2 Chair Arbitration is triggered automatically.

• If an applicant receives a "FUND" recommendation from one evaluator and a "REJECT" from another (polar contradiction), the Committee Chair must arbitrate.

2. Chair Role:

• The Chair reviews documentary evidence, verifies citations against the raw student record, and provides an arbitrated consensus score.

• The Chair drafts the official **Fellowship Summary Report (FSR)** and award notification letter.

Section 2: Human-in-the-Loop Final Sign-Off

• Automated decisions cannot disburse institutional funds without the digital signature of the Committee Chair or Dean of Student Financial Services.

• The Chair retains authority to adjust awards based on special family circumstances, medical expenses, or emergency appeals.